

POLICY PITCH

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Alabama

“Mold is a unique issue in Alabama” (University of Alabama EHS)

40%

of Universities show
signs of mold in the US
(Lanthier-Veilleux et al.)

#4

in the nation for mold
risk
(American Home Shield)

0

Alabama laws
requiring mold testing
or standards
(ADPH)

Health Stakes

Physical

- Respiratory irritation, worsening asthma, skin problems, hair loss, disrupted sleep (CDC)

Cognitive

- Brain fog, short-term memory loss, impaired executive function (NIH)

Mental Health

- 34-44% higher risk of depression in moldy environments (Shenassa et al.)

Workforce

- Improved air quality measurably improved cognitive scores (Allen et al.)

Every college and university in Alabama with student housing should be required to complete annual mold and moisture testing before students move in, conducted by a licensed, independent third-party inspector.

5 Components

1. Full-building testing each summer
2. Independent inspectors
3. Mandatory remediation before occupancy if issues are found
4. Post-remediation clearance testing
5. Annual campus health summary published

Cost

- **Unfunded state mandate:** cost passed to students as universities see fit
- **Inspection:** \$500–\$1,000 per building (Mold Inspection & Testing)
- **Remediation if ignored:** \$1,500–\$4,000 (Clean Image AL)

Oversight

- ACAC or IAC2 certified inspectors only
- Oversight body: ADPH or ACHE.
- Non-compliance flagged publicly

Timeline

- Year 1:** pilot in highest-risk, oldest buildings
- Year 2:** full statewide rollout

Alabama's future starts in a dorm room.
Let's make sure it's a safe one.

Sources

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Enforcement

State office collects annual compliance docs.

Non-compliance flagged publicly in annual report.

Oversight body: ADPH or ACHE.

Public transparency creates accountability.

Thresholds

No federal indoor mold standard currently exists (EPA).

Thresholds developed post-passage with ACAC/IAC2 certified professionals.

Aligned with existing EPA and CDC guidance.

Professional air and surface sampling replaces visual inspection only.

Private Institutions

Policy applies to institutions receiving state financial aid dollars.

Students required to live on campus forfeit housing choice.

State has legitimate interest in safety of mandated housing.

Precedent: fire codes, ADA compliance, food safety standards apply to private institutions.

Small Institutions

Year 1 pilot limits scope to highest-risk buildings only.

Competitive vendor bidding keeps costs predictable.

Inspection (\$500–\$1,000) vs. emergency remediation (\$1,500–\$4,000+).

Phased rollout gives smaller schools time to plan and budget.

Precedent

No state currently requires pre-move-in university mold testing.

Alabama opportunity to lead. 13 states have adopted ACAC inspector certification standards.

Mold disclosure laws exist in FL, TX, NY and others.

Professional infrastructure already exists nationwide.

Remediation Cost

Remediation only triggered when testing finds unsafe levels.

Summer remediation = planned, controllable cost.

Mid-semester emergency remediation = crisis cost + relocation + legal exposure.

Alabama average remediation: \$1,500–\$4,000 (Clean Image AL, 2024).

Early detection consistently reduces total remediation cost.